

Microsoft 365 — App Registration for Sign in with Microsoft (SSO)

One Helpdesk / Ticketing Platform
Setup guide for the Project Lead

What this is for

This app lets the people in your organisation **sign in to the helpdesk with their Microsoft (Entra ID) account** instead of a helpdesk username and password. It uses **OpenID Connect** — Microsoft proves who the person is, and the helpdesk then logs them in. It applies to every role (admins, agents, and end-users/requestors).

This is a different app from the Mailbox connector. Register a **separate** app for SSO. See the companion guide *Azure App for Mailbox*.

Who performs this: a person who can **register an app** in Microsoft Entra (Application Administrator / Global Administrator).

Before you start — copy the Redirect URI

The **Redirect URI** is **always shown in the helpdesk settings**; don't type it by hand. Go to **Tenant Settings** → **Authentication** (the gear → *Authentication & SSO*) and use the **Copy** button next to **Redirect URI**. You'll paste this value into Azure in Part A (Steps 1 and 3). Always copy the **current** value from Settings — Microsoft matches it character-for-character, so an exact copy matters.

Part A — Register the app in Microsoft Entra

Step 1 — Create the registration

1. Go to the [Microsoft Entra admin center](#) (or the [Azure Portal](#) → **Microsoft Entra ID**).
2. **App registrations** → **+ New registration**.
3. **Name:** e.g. `Helpdesk SSO`.
4. **Supported account types:** **Accounts in this organizational directory only (Single tenant)**.
Important — single tenant is required. It is what limits sign-in to your own staff and makes first-time auto-provisioning safe. (The helpdesk will **reject** a multi-tenant value such as “common”.)
5. **Redirect URI:** platform **Web** → paste the **Redirect URI** you copied above.
6. Click **Register**.

Step 2 — Copy the two IDs

On the app's **Overview** page, copy:

- **Application (client) ID** — a GUID.
- **Directory (tenant) ID** — a GUID. (*Must be this GUID, not “common”.*)

Step 3 — Confirm the Redirect URI (if not set in Step 1)

1. Open **Authentication**.
2. Under **Platform configurations** → **Web** → **Redirect URIs**, ensure the helpdesk Redirect URI is listed; add it and **Save** if needed.
3. You do **not** need to enable implicit grant / ID tokens — the helpdesk uses the secure authorization-code flow.

Step 4 — Create a client secret

1. **Certificates & secrets** → **Client secrets** → **+ New client secret**.
2. Add a description and an expiry (e.g. 24 months). Click **Add**.
3. **Immediately copy the secret Value** (not the *Secret ID*). It is shown only once.

Copy the **Value** column. The *Secret ID* will **not** work.

Step 5 — (Recommended) ensure email is returned

The helpdesk matches Microsoft users to helpdesk accounts by **email**.

1. Open **Token configuration** → **+ Add optional claim**.
2. Token type **ID**, tick **email**, click **Add** (accept the prompt to enable the basic Microsoft Graph **email** permission if asked).

No admin consent for anything beyond basic sign-in is required — the default **openid / profile / email / User.Read** permissions are sufficient.

Part B — Enter the details in the helpdesk

1. Back in **Tenant Settings** → **Authentication**, enter:
 - **Application (client) ID** — from Step 2
 - **Directory (tenant) ID** — from Step 2 (the GUID)
 - **Client secret** — the **Value** from Step 4
2. (Optional) **Allowed email domains** — e.g. **yourcompany.com**. Only these domains may auto-create accounts on first sign-in. Blank = anyone in your directory.
3. (Optional) **Auto-create first-time users** — on by default; a first-time Microsoft sign-in with no existing account creates a portal **Requestor**. Turn it off to allow only pre-created users.
4. Turn on **Enable “Sign in with Microsoft”** and **Save**.

A **“Sign in with Microsoft”** button now appears on your organisation’s login page.

How your users sign in

- When you **create a user**, choose their **Sign-in method**: *Username & password* or *Microsoft (SSO)*. For a Microsoft user, **email is required** and no password is created. The choice is per user, so you can mix both in one organisation.
- **Break-glass**: admins can **always** still sign in with a password, even if their method is Microsoft — so a misconfigured app can’t lock you out. To set a break-glass password for an admin, use **Users** → **Reset password**.

Values to hand over

From Entra	Goes into Tenant Settings → Authentication
Application (client) ID	Application (client) ID
Directory (tenant) ID (GUID)	Directory (tenant) ID
Client secret Value	Client secret
Redirect URI (copied from Settings)	register it in Entra → Authentication

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause / fix
AADSTS50011: redirect URI does not match	The Redirect URI in Entra differs from the one on the Authentication page. Copy it again exactly (including the trailing <code>/</code>).
AADSTS7000215: Invalid client secret	You used the Secret ID instead of the Value , or the secret expired. Create a new secret and paste its Value .
"This Microsoft account belongs to a different directory."	The Directory (tenant) ID is wrong, or the user is from another tenant. Use a single-tenant app + your own Directory ID (GUID).
The helpdesk won't save "common" as the tenant	Intentional — a single-tenant GUID is required. Use the Directory (tenant) ID from the app's Overview page.
"No account exists for this Microsoft user..."	Auto-create is off (or the domain isn't allowed) and no matching account exists. Create the user first, or enable auto-create / add the domain.
Button doesn't appear on the login page	SSO isn't enabled , or one of Client ID / Tenant ID / secret is missing.
Sign-in stops working after some weeks	The client secret expired . Create a new secret in Entra and paste the new Value.

Security notes

- Each organisation uses its own **single-tenant** app, so only accounts from **your** Microsoft directory can ever sign in.
- The client secret is stored **encrypted** and is never shown back in the UI or API.
- Rotate the **client secret** before its expiry date to avoid an outage.